
DERIVN

CLIENT HANDBOOK / EDITION 01

Built for *Motion.*

A practical operating manual for strength,
running, nutrition, recovery, and the consistency
that holds them together.

THE DERIVN SYSTEM

TRAIN. RUN. EAT. RECOVER. REPEAT.

Disclaimer

This handbook is for educational purposes. It does not replace medical care, physical therapy, individualized nutrition counseling, or professional diagnosis.

If you have pain, injury, medical conditions, dietary restrictions, or are pregnant or postpartum, consult an appropriate professional before applying any recommendation in this guide.

The principles here are designed to be conservative, sustainable, and adaptable. Use them as a framework. Modify them when your situation calls for it. The system serves you, not the other way around.

READER STANDARD

Train within your current capability. Progress gradually. Stop any movement that causes sharp or unfamiliar pain. Get checked when something feels off.

How to Use This Handbook

This handbook is designed to be used, not just read. You do not need to memorize it. Start with the section that solves your current problem, apply it, and return for the next one.

IT FUNCTIONS AS FIVE THINGS

- A training reference
- A nutrition guide
- A weekly planning tool
- A troubleshooting manual
- A consistency reset

THE BEST WAY TO USE THIS

01 Read Start Here first.

It frames every decision in the rest of the manual.

02 Pick one current priority.

Fat loss, strength, running, consistency, or recovery. Choose one.

03 Apply one section at a time.

Do not overhaul your life in a single week.

04 Return to the troubleshooting sections when progress slows.

The mistake chapters exist for that exact moment.

05 Use the rules as a default, not a ceiling.

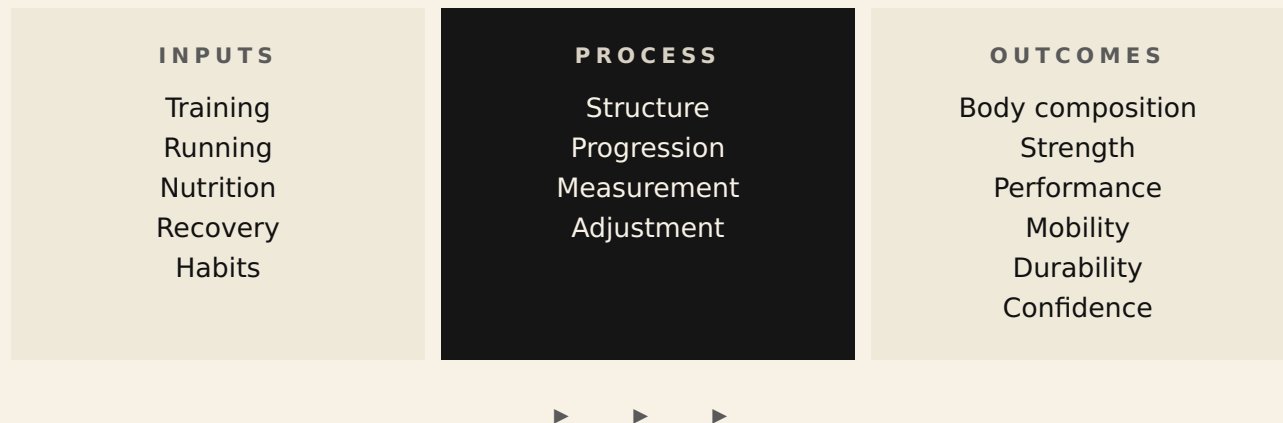
Meet the standards on hard weeks. Exceed them when life allows.

KEY TAKEAWAY

You do not need more information. You need a structure that turns information into action.

The Derivn System

Five inputs run through four operations and produce six outcomes. The job of the system is to make the right actions repeatable.



OPERATING PRINCIPLE

The goal is not to do more. The goal is to build a system that makes the right actions repeatable, then run it long enough for compounding to take over.

HOW TO READ THIS MAP

Every chapter that follows feeds into one of these five inputs or one of these four operations. When something stalls, the limiting variable is almost always one of the inputs being inconsistent or one of the operations being skipped.

01

START HERE

What this system is, who it is for, and what it is built to deliver.

SECTION 01

THE DERIVN SYSTEM

What This Handbook Is

A complete operating system for training, nutrition, running, recovery, and consistency. Not a workout list. Not a diet plan. Not a transformation pitch.

WHAT IT IS

- A coaching framework you can run yourself
- A reference manual for weekly planning
- A way to combine lifting and running without conflict
- A nutrition structure built around real food and real life
- A long-term operating standard, not a six-week sprint

WHAT IT IS NOT

- A randomized workout collection
- A restrictive diet
- A peak-performance manual that assumes ideal conditions
- A motivational pep talk

THIS HANDBOOK HELPS YOU ANSWER

- How should I train?
- How should I run?
- How should I eat?
- How do I combine lifting and running?
- What do I do when life gets busy?
- How do I know if I am making progress?
- How do I keep going long-term?

KEY TAKEAWAY

You do not need more random fitness information. You need a structure that turns information into repeatable action.

Who This Is For

This system is built for capable adults who want a body that performs and a routine that survives real life. It assumes you have trained before, even if you have lost the structure recently.

THIS IS FOR YOU IF

- You have trained before but lost structure.
- You want strength and conditioning together.
- You want to improve body composition without extreme dieting.
- You want to run without losing muscle.
- You want a routine that survives real life.
- You want clear rules instead of constant guessing.

THIS IS NOT FOR YOU IF

- You want an extreme 30-day transformation.
- You want a bodybuilding-only program.
- You want a marathon-only program.
- You want a crash diet.
- You want maximum results at any cost.
- You are unwilling to track or structure anything.

COACH'S NOTE

Most people do not need a more aggressive plan. They need a plan they can actually run for twelve months without falling off. That is who this is built for.

KEY TAKEAWAY

This system is for people who want capable, sustainable fitness. Not temporary intensity.

What We Are Building

A body that only looks good but cannot perform is incomplete. A body that performs but constantly breaks down is incomplete. Built for Motion develops all five qualities together.

THE FIVE PHYSICAL OUTCOMES

01 BODY COMPOSITION Less unnecessary body fat while maintaining or building muscle.	02 STRENGTH Usable strength across squat, hinge, push, pull, carry, and stabilize.	03 PERFORMANCE Aerobic capacity and the ability to sustain effort.	04 MOBILITY Active control through useful ranges of motion.	05 DURABILITY The ability to keep training for years without burning out or breaking down.
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WHY ALL FIVE

Most fitness systems chase one of these and ignore the others. The result is predictable.

- Aesthetics-only training collapses under any real-world physical demand.
- Strength-only training builds capable lifters with poor cardiovascular health.
- Endurance-only training erodes muscle mass and joint resilience.
- Mobility-only training improves range without producing capability.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

The goal is capability. Appearance is a byproduct of a capable body.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Build all five outcomes together. They reinforce each other. Chasing only one creates fragility.

02

THE DERIVN PHILOSOPHY

The principles that govern every decision in the system.

SECTION 02

THE DERIVN SYSTEM

Train to Pass

You do not need perfect weeks. You need repeatable weeks. Train to Pass is the standard that keeps the system running through real life.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most plans only work under ideal conditions. Real life is not ideal. Work gets busy. Sleep gets disrupted. Travel happens. Stress happens. Motivation drops. A good system still works when the week is imperfect.

A PASSING WEEK

- Minimum training completed
- Protein at most meals
- Easy runs done
- Sleep protected when possible
- Misses corrected the next day
- Repeatable next week

A “PERFECT” WEEK

- Every workout completed
- Every meal tracked
- Sleep flawless every night
- Motivation high all seven days
- Zero disruptions
- Rarely realistic

THE STANDARD

The goal is not 100% execution. The goal is enough execution repeated long enough to compound.

HOW TO APPLY TRAIN TO PASS

- Set a realistic minimum number of weekly sessions.
- Treat the minimum as non-negotiable, even when shortened.
- Stop chasing perfect macros. Hit your protein target most days.
- Move missed sessions instead of skipping them.
- Score your week pass or fail. Anything above the minimum is a pass.

KEY TAKEAWAY

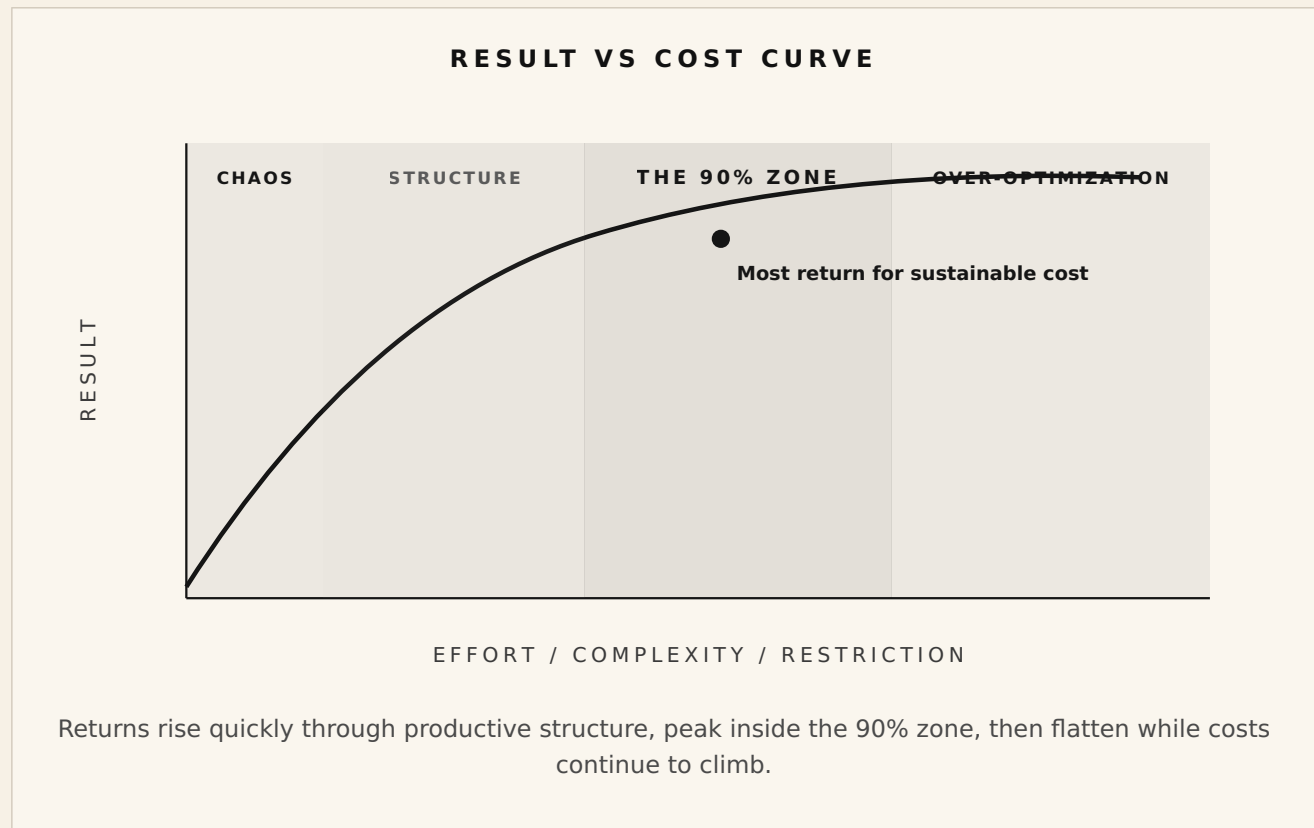
A passing week repeated for months beats a perfect week followed by a collapse.

The 90% Principle

Most people get the majority of meaningful results from doing the basics consistently, without chasing the final layer of extreme optimization. Derivn lives in the 90% zone for almost every client.

WHY THE LAST 10% COSTS TOO MUCH

- More time
- More recovery demand
- More joint stress
- More dietary restriction
- More mental bandwidth
- More lifestyle disruption



OPERATING ZONE

Derivn lives in the 90% zone. Train hard enough to keep growing. Live well enough to keep showing up.

KEY TAKEAWAY

The best system is not the one that maximizes everything. It is the one that produces strong results at a cost you can sustain.

Why Most Fitness Systems Fail

People rarely fail from laziness. They fail because the plan was not built for the life they actually live. The same five failure points repeat over and over.

FAILURE POINT	WHY IT BREAKS	THE CORRECTION
Motivation Dependency	The plan only works when motivation is high. Most days, it is not.	Use structure, scheduled sessions, and a defined minimum.
Extreme Starts	Too much change too fast. Five new habits at once almost always collapse.	Build gradually over 12 weeks. One or two changes at a time.
Unnecessary Complexity	Every extra decision is friction. Friction kills consistency.	Use simple templates and repeatable rules.
One-Dimensional Training	Chasing only fat loss, only strength, or only running.	Train all five physical outcomes together.
No Sustainability Plan	The 12-week program ends and old habits return.	Build a system you intend to maintain indefinitely.

COACH'S NOTE

If you have started over multiple times, the program was probably not the problem. The structure around the program was. Fix the structure first.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Most people do not fail because they are lazy. They fail because the system was not built for real life.

DERIVN / BUILT FOR MOTION HANDBOOK

03

STRENGTH TRAINING SYSTEM

How to build strength that transfers, protects the
body, and lasts.

SECTION 03

THE DERIVN SYSTEM

The Strength Training Rules

Ten rules govern every strength session in the system. They protect the body, drive progress, and keep training repeatable for years.

01 Movement quality comes first.

If you cannot control the rep, the load is wrong.

02 Compound lifts are the foundation.

Squat, hinge, push, pull, carry, stabilize. Build the program around these patterns.

03 Unilateral work is not optional.

Life is asymmetrical. So is running. Train one side at a time, every week.

04 The posterior chain is a priority.

Glutes, hamstrings, back, rear delts. Most people are short on the back side.

05 Pull at least as much as you push.

Aim for a 1:1 minimum, ideally 1.5:1 pulling to pushing.

06 Progress gradually.

Add a rep, add a small load, or improve quality. Stack small wins.

07 Stop most sets with 1 to 3 reps in reserve.

Failure on every set is not the goal. Adaptation is.

08 Manage fatigue before it manages you.

If you wait until you are wrecked, you have waited too long.

09 Warm up before loading.

5 to 10 minutes of activation before the first heavy set.

10 Deload before you are forced to stop.

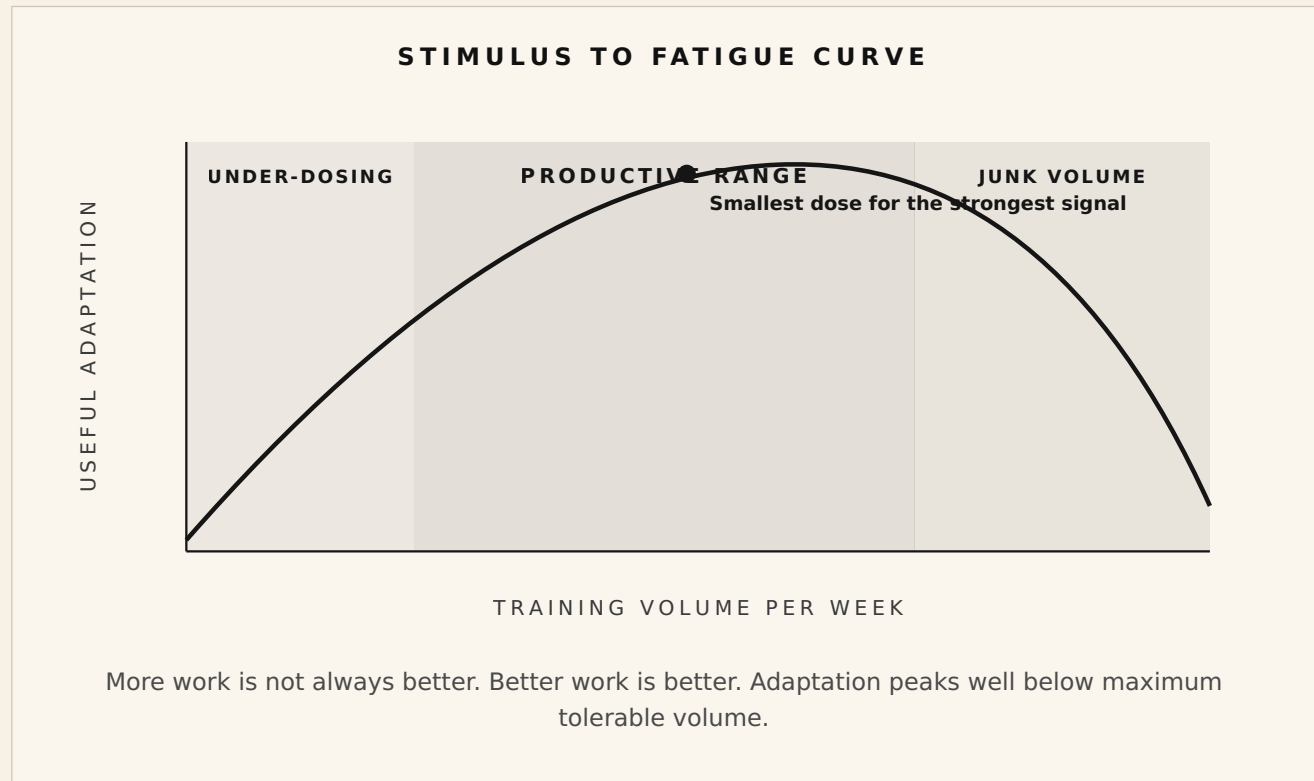
Planned recovery weeks every 4 to 6 weeks.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Strength that lasts is built through controlled progression. Reckless intensity is borrowed strength that you eventually pay back with injury.

Stimulus vs Fatigue

Every set creates two things. Stimulus, the signal to adapt. And fatigue, the cost of creating that signal. The job of programming is to maximize the first while controlling the second.



DO THIS

- Use enough sets to progress.
- Stop the set when quality drops.
- Track performance 24 to 48 hours later.
- Add volume only when recovery is good.

AVOID THIS

- Adding exercises just to fill time.
- Chasing soreness as a measure of effort.
- Training every set to failure.
- Letting one session ruin the next session.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Find the smallest amount of work that produces a strong adaptation signal. Then repeat that work until it stops working, and only then add more.

Movement Quality First

The weight only matters if you can control it. Form is not aesthetic. It is what determines whether the load actually trains the muscle and whether your joints survive the next ten years.

WHAT GOOD MOVEMENT LOOKS LIKE

- Full usable range of motion
- Controlled lowering phase, never dropped
- Stable joints, especially knees, hips, and shoulders
- Consistent reps from first to last
- No major compensation pattern
- No sharp pain
- No ego loading

REP QUALITY CHECKLIST

Before increasing the weight, ask:

- Can I control the lowering phase?
- Can I keep the same form on every rep?
- Can I move through the intended range?
- Can I finish the set without joint pain?
- Could I repeat this form next week?

If you answered yes to all five, progress. If even one is no, what do you do?

ALL YES

Add a rep, add a small load, or add a set next session. The signal is ready for more.

ANY NO

Hold the load. Or reduce it. Earn the next jump by hitting clean reps for at least one more session.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Poor form inflates short-term numbers and limits long-term progress. The rep that does not look like the others is the rep you should not have done.

Compound Lifts

Six movement patterns cover almost every meaningful strength outcome. Build the week around them. Add isolation work after, not in place of.

PATTERN	EXAMPLES	WHAT IT BUILDS
Squat	Goblet squat, front squat, back squat, split squat	Quads, glutes, lower body control, knee resilience.
Hinge	Trap bar deadlift, Romanian deadlift, hip thrust	Posterior chain, glutes, hamstrings, low back durability.
Push	Dumbbell bench, push-up, overhead press	Chest, shoulders, triceps, upper body strength.
Pull	Rows, pull-ups, lat pulldowns	Back, posture, shoulder health, pulling strength.
Carry	Farmer carry, suitcase carry, overhead carry	Grip, traps, core, real-world strength.
Core Stability	Plank, dead bug, Pallof press, loaded carry	Anti-rotation, anti-extension, spinal protection.

WEEKLY STANDARD

Every training week should hit all six movement patterns. If a pattern is missing, the program is incomplete, regardless of how many other exercises you do.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Cover the six patterns. Get strong in them. Everything else is supporting work.

Unilateral Work

Unilateral training means training one side at a time. It builds the control that bilateral lifts cannot. Every running stride is a single-leg event. Every carry, step, and lunge involves asymmetry. Train it directly.

LOWER BODY	UPPER BODY
Bulgarian split squat	Single-arm dumbbell row
Reverse lunge	Single-arm dumbbell press
Step-up	Half-kneeling press
Single-leg Romanian deadlift	Half-kneeling cable row
Single-leg hip thrust	Single-arm carry (suitcase or overhead)

HOW TO USE UNILATERAL WORK

- At least one unilateral lower body movement each lower body session.
- At least one unilateral upper body movement each upper body session.
- Always start the set with the weaker side.
- Match the stronger side's reps to the weaker side's reps.
- Progress gradually. Single-leg work humbles fast.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Bilateral lifts build force. Unilateral work builds control. You need both.

Posterior Chain Priority

Most adults sit too much, push too much, and pull too little. The fix is structural: prioritize the back side of the body in every training week.

Muscles in the Posterior Chain

- Glutes
- Hamstrings
- Upper back
- Lats
- Rear delts
- Spinal erectors
- Calves

Why It Matters

- Protects knees, hips, and lower back
- Improves posture
- Supports running mechanics
- Balances pressing and sitting-heavy lifestyles
- Builds durable strength that lasts decades

WEEKLY POSTERIOR CHAIN MINIMUMS

- 1 to 2 hinge movements
- 2 to 4 rowing or pulling movements
- 1 to 2 glute-focused exercises
- Direct upper back work
- Pull-to-push ratio of at least 1:1, ideally 1.5:1

COACH'S NOTE

If you have stubborn lower back issues, weak glutes, or chronic posture complaints, the answer is almost always more posterior chain work, not more stretching.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Most people are front-side dominant. Built for Motion corrects that by prioritizing the back side of the body.

Reps in Reserve

Reps in Reserve, or RIR, is the number of reps you could still complete if forced. It is the simplest tool for managing effort across years of training.

RIR	EFFORT LEVEL	WHEN TO USE
RIR 4	Very easy, 4 reps left in tank	Warm-up sets and deload weeks.
RIR 3	Productive but controlled	Compound work early in a block.
RIR 2	Challenging, solid working set	Most working sets on compounds.
RIR 1	Hard, last reps slow	Final sets, late in a block, used carefully.
RIR 0	Failure	Mostly isolation work. Rare on compounds.

DEFAULT RIR TARGETS

- Compound lifts: 1 to 3 RIR
- Unilateral work: 1 to 2 RIR
- Isolation work: 0 to 2 RIR
- Deload weeks: 3 to 5 RIR

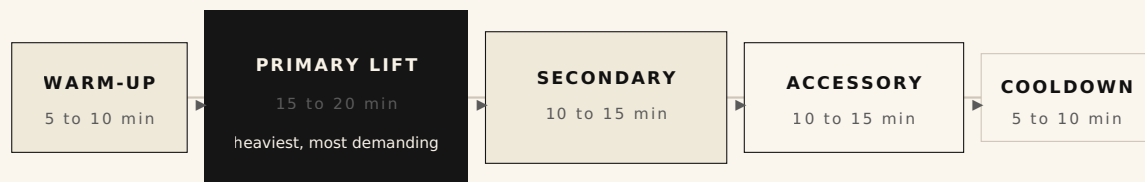
KEY TAKEAWAY

You do not need to fail every set to build strength. You need enough effort to adapt and enough recovery to repeat.

Strength Workout Structure

A good session is not random. The most demanding work goes first. Every exercise has a job. Every minute is intentional.

THE FIVE-PHASE STRENGTH SESSION



Demand drops as the session progresses. The hardest, highest-skill work is always front-loaded.

SAMPLE LOWER BODY SESSION

Warm-up	5 minutes dynamic movement, 2 ramp-up sets
Primary	Trap bar deadlift, 4 sets of 5 at RIR 2
Secondary	Bulgarian split squat, 3 sets of 8 per side
Accessory	Hip thrust, 3 sets of 10
Core	Pallof press, 2 sets of 12 per side
Cooldown	Hip flexor stretch, hamstring stretch, ankle mobility

KEY TAKEAWAY

Hardest work first. Every block has a job. Cooldown is part of the session, not optional.

04

RUNNING AND CONDITIONING

How to build endurance without sacrificing strength.

SECTION 04

THE DERIVN SYSTEM

Why Running Belongs

Running fills the cardiovascular gap that strength training alone cannot close. It is one of the highest-return tools you have for body composition, recovery, and long-term health.

WHAT RUNNING IMPROVES

- Aerobic capacity
- Recovery between sets
- Recovery between sessions
- Fat oxidation
- Body composition
- Heart health
- Mental resilience
- Long-term durability

THE COMMON FEAR, ADDRESSED

Running does not automatically destroy muscle. Muscle loss happens when running volume is excessive, calories are too low, protein is too low, or strength training is removed. Solve those four variables and running becomes a benefit, not a tax.

OPERATING STANDARD

A capable body runs. Even at low volume. Even at slow pace. Cardiovascular fitness is non-negotiable.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Running is not the enemy of strength. Poor programming is.

Zone 2 Training

Zone 2 is easy aerobic work performed at a conversational pace. It is supposed to feel almost too easy. The adaptation comes from repeatable low-intensity volume, not from how hard a single session feels.

HOW TO KNOW YOU ARE IN ZONE 2

- You can speak in full sentences without gasping.
- Breathing is controlled and rhythmic.
- You feel like you could keep going for another 30 minutes.
- It almost feels too easy. That is the point.

WHAT IT BUILDS

- Mitochondrial density
- Improved fat oxidation
- Increased capillary density
- A stronger heart at rest and under load
- Better recovery between hard sessions
- Minimal accumulated fatigue

ZONE 2 RULES

- Start with 2 sessions per week.
- Run for 25 to 40 minutes per session.
- Slow down if you cannot talk.
- Walking breaks are allowed and encouraged early on.
- Do not turn easy runs into moderate runs.

COACH'S NOTE

Most runners run their easy days too hard and their hard days too easy. The result is months of moderate effort that builds nothing in particular. Pick a lane and stay in it.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Zone 2 feels easy because it is supposed to. The adaptation is in the repetition, not the intensity.

Threshold Training

Threshold work is hard but controlled running near the fastest pace you could sustain for 20 to 30 minutes. It raises your aerobic ceiling. Zone 2 builds the base underneath.

SESSION TYPE	EXAMPLE WORKOUT
Steady tempo	10 min easy, 20 min at threshold, 10 min easy
Cruise intervals	4 x 5 min at threshold, 90 sec easy jog between
Progressive tempo	10 min easy, 10 min moderate, 10 min threshold, 5 min easy

THRESHOLD RULES

- One threshold session per week, maximum.
- Build at least 4 to 6 weeks of easy running before adding it.
- Separate by 48 hours from heavy lower body lifting.
- Effort should feel hard but controlled, never like a race.
- If form breaks down, end the rep and finish the session easy.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Threshold training raises the ceiling. Zone 2 builds the base. Both belong in the system. Neither replaces the other.

Speed and Intervals

Speed work is a sharpening tool, not the foundation. It improves running economy, top-end speed, and neuromuscular efficiency. It cannot fix a missing aerobic base.

LEVEL	SAMPLE SESSION
Beginner	6 x 20 sec fast, 90 sec walk between
Intermediate	6 x 400m hard, 2 min easy jog between
Advanced	8 x 400m or 5 x 800m, depending on goal

RULES FOR SPEED WORK

- Warm up fully. Always.
- Keep total volume low. Quality over quantity.
- Use only after a real running base is built.
- Do not combine with heavy leg days.
- Stop before mechanics break down.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Speed work works when it is small, sharp, and placed correctly. Too much of it ruins everything else.

The Three-Run System

Three runs cover almost every meaningful adaptation: an easy long run, a quality run, and a recovery run. Most weeks need two easy runs and one hard run. That is the operating ratio.

THE THREE RUNS

RUN 01 EASY LONG RUN Build aerobic base Zone 2 30 to 60 min EASY	RUN 02 QUALITY RUN Threshold or intervals Hard, controlled 30 to 45 min total	RUN 03 RECOVERY RUN Blood flow, low fatigue Very easy 20 to 30 min EASY
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Two easy runs, one hard run. Most weeks. Most years.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Most running should be easy. One run per week can be hard. This balance builds fitness without wrecking recovery.

Running Without Losing Muscle

Muscle loss while running is a programming and nutrition problem, not a running problem. Solve four variables and you can run consistently while still gaining strength.

MUSCLE PROTECTION CHECKLIST

- Keep strength training in the plan.
- Eat enough total calories.
- Keep protein at 0.8 to 1.0 grams per pound of body weight.
- Fuel hard sessions with carbohydrates.
- Keep most runs easy.
- Do not increase mileage aggressively.
- Track strength numbers as your early warning system.

SYMPTOM	LIKELY CAUSE	FIX
Strength dropping and weight dropping fast	Calories too low	Increase intake, especially carbs and protein.
Legs always tired	Running too hard or too close to leg day	Move the hard run. Slow the easy runs.
Soreness lasting all week	Volume increased too quickly	Reduce mileage and hold steady for 2 to 3 weeks.
Lifts feel heavier than the load	Under-recovery, often nutrition driven	Add a meal. Add an hour of sleep. Reassess in a week.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Running does not cause muscle loss by itself. Underfueling and poor scheduling do. Fix the inputs and the outputs follow.

05

BUILDING THE TRAINING WEEK

How to make strength, running, and recovery
work together.

SECTION 05

THE DERIVN SYSTEM

Weekly Scheduling Rules

The week is one system, not seven separate decisions. Three rules govern almost every scheduling choice.

01 Separate hard sessions by 48 hours.

Hard lower body, threshold runs, and intervals all need recovery space between them.

02 Easy sessions can go almost anywhere.

Zone 2 runs, recovery runs, mobility, and walks have low cost and high flexibility.

03 Take at least one full rest day per week.

Mobility and walking still count as a rest day. Lifting does not.

HARD SESSIONS

- Heavy lower body lifting
- Threshold runs
- Interval runs
- Very long runs
- High-volume full body days

EASY SESSIONS

- Zone 2 runs
- Recovery runs
- Mobility
- Light upper body work
- Walking

KEY TAKEAWAY

Hard sessions get spacing. Easy sessions are flexible. One full rest day is non-negotiable.

Hard Days vs Easy Days

The most common training mistake is the gray zone. Every session is moderately hard, so nothing is truly high quality and nothing is truly restorative. Pick a lane each day.

HARD DAYS

- Heavy compound lifts
- Quality runs
- Higher nervous system demand
- Should be challenging
- Need recovery after

EASY DAYS

- Zone 2 running
- Recovery runs and walks
- Mobility
- Should leave you feeling better than you started
- Low fatigue cost

AVOID THE GRAY ZONE

If every workout is a 7 out of 10, your hard days are not hard enough to drive adaptation, and your easy days are not easy enough to allow recovery. The compromise costs you both.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Hard days hard. Easy days easy. Do not turn every day into the middle.

Sequencing Strength and Running

Most hybrid training problems are scheduling problems, not compatibility problems. Strength and running coexist when the order is right.

Are you doing heavy lower body today?

YES

Avoid hard running within 48 hours.
Easy Zone 2 is acceptable if you are well adapted.

NO

Upper body can pair with easy running.
Quality runs can be placed away from leg days.

SEQUENCING RULES

- Heavy lower body and hard running need 48 to 72 hours of separation.
- Upper body and easy running are compatible same-day.
- Easy runs are flexible. Place them where they fit life.
- If doubling, lift first when strength is the priority.
- Run first when the run is the priority.
- Never combine a hard run and a heavy leg day as a normal practice.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Most hybrid training problems are scheduling problems, not compatibility problems. Solve the order before you blame the program.

Sample Weekly Templates

Five templates cover most situations. Pick the one that fits your life today, not the one you wish fit. The principles matter more than the exact days.

TEMPLATE A / BEGINNER

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
MON Full Body Strength	TUE Easy Run or Walk	WED <i>Rest or Mobility</i>	THU Full Body Strength	FRI Easy Run or Walk	SAT Full Body Strength	SUN <i>Rest</i>

TEMPLATE B / INTERMEDIATE

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
MON Lower Body Strength	TUE Zone 2 Run + Upper	WED <i>Rest or Recovery Run</i>	THU Quality Run	FRI Upper Body Strength	SAT Lower Body Moderate	SUN Easy Long Run

TEMPLATE C / BUSY ADULT

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
MON 30-Min Full Body	TUE Zone 2 Walk or Run	WED <i>Rest</i>	THU 30-Min Full Body	FRI Optional Zone 2	SAT Full Body Strength	SUN <i>Rest or Mobility</i>

TEMPLATE D / STRENGTH PRIORITY

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
MON Heavy Lower	TUE Upper + Easy Run	WED <i>Rest</i>	THU Upper, Pull Focus	FRI Quality Run or Zone 2	SAT Lower Moderate	SUN Easy Long Run or Rest

TEMPLATE E / RUNNING PRIORITY

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
MON Full Body Strength	TUE Quality Run	WED Upper + Recovery Run	THU <i>Rest</i>	FRI Lower Moderate	SAT Easy Long Run	SUN Mobility or Rest

HOW TO CHOOSE

- New to consistent training: Template A
- Established lifter, want both strength and running: Template B
- Limited time, traveling, or stressed: Template C
- Strength is the goal, running is supportive: Template D
- Running event approaching, strength is supportive: Template E

KEY TAKEAWAY

Choose the template that fits your life. Stay on it for at least 6 to 8 weeks before judging it.

DERIVN / BUILT FOR MOTION HANDBOOK

06

NUTRITION FOUNDATIONS

How to eat for fat loss, performance, recovery,
and consistency.

SECTION 06

THE DERIVN SYSTEM

Nutrition as the Multiplier

Training creates the signal. Nutrition determines how well the body responds. If nutrition does not support training, results are limited regardless of effort in the gym.

WHAT NUTRITION CONTROLS

- Energy intake
- Protein availability
- Muscle repair
- Glycogen replenishment
- Hunger and appetite
- Recovery quality
- Body composition over time

NUTRITION PRIORITY HIERARCHY

- 01 Calories** Determines weight direction.
- 02 Protein** Anchors muscle, recovery, satiety.
- 03 Whole-Food Foundation** 80% of intake from minimally processed foods.
- 04 Carbs Matched to Activity** More on training days, less on rest days.
- 05 Fats Controlled** Essential, but calorie-dense. Measure them.
- 06 Timing Around Training** Useful, not magical.
- 07 Supplements** A small final layer. Not a foundation.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Nutrition does not need to be perfect. It does need structure. Get the top three priorities right and the rest takes care of itself.

Calories

Calories are energy. They are also the only nutrition variable that determines weight direction. Macronutrients matter, but they operate inside whatever calorie envelope you set.

GOAL	TARGET	PRACTICAL NOTES
Fat loss	300 to 500 calorie deficit	Sustainable rate. Larger deficits cost muscle and recovery.
Maintenance	Eat around expenditure	Used between dieting phases or to consolidate body composition.
Muscle and performance	200 to 300 calorie surplus	Most muscle gain happens in modest surpluses, not large ones.

THE MOST COMMON FAILURE

Combining a low food intake with high training volume. The body protects itself by reducing recovery, energy, and eventually muscle. The deficit you can sustain beats the deficit you can suffer through for two weeks.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Fat loss requires a deficit. The best deficit is the one you can repeat for 8 to 12 weeks without breaking down.

Protein

Protein is the anchor of every meal. It protects muscle, drives recovery, and controls hunger better than any other macronutrient. Get it right and many other problems disappear.

DAILY TARGETS

- Total daily intake: 0.8 to 1.0 grams per pound of body weight
- Per meal: 30 to 45 grams
- Distribution: 3 to 4 protein-anchored meals per day

WHY PROTEIN MATTERS

- Preserves muscle during fat loss
- Drives recovery between sessions
- Builds muscle when calories support it
- Keeps you full
- Has the highest thermic effect of any macro
- Stabilizes blood sugar and energy

LEAN PROTEINS / DEFAULT	HIGHER-FAT PROTEINS / USE WHEN CALORIES ALLOW
Chicken breast	Whole eggs
Turkey breast	Salmon
White fish	Chicken thighs
Egg whites	Lean steak
93% lean beef	Cheese (controlled portions)
Nonfat Greek yogurt	Full-fat dairy
Low-fat cottage cheese	
Whey protein, tuna, shrimp	

KEY TAKEAWAY

Protein at every meal. Build the meal around it. Everything else fits around the protein, not the other way around.

Carbohydrates

Carbs are fuel. They are not the enemy. They drive lifting performance, running performance, glycogen replenishment, recovery, and mood. Match them to activity and they earn their place in every meal.

CONTEXT	TARGET	BEST SOURCES
Training day	Higher carb intake	Rice, potatoes, oats, fruit, pasta, bread, sweet potatoes
Rest day	Lower to moderate	Fruit, vegetables, smaller portions of rice, potatoes, oats
Pre-workout	Quick, moderate	Banana, oats, rice cakes, small rice bowl
Post-workout	Protein plus carbs	Chicken and rice, Greek yogurt with oats, shake with banana

THE CARB RULE

Match carbs to activity. Harder training days need more fuel. Rest days need less. The body is honest about this if you let it be.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Carbs are not optional for trainees. They are the fuel that allows you to keep showing up at intensity.

Fats

Fat is essential. It is also the most calorie-dense macronutrient at 9 calories per gram, more than double protein and carbs at 4. The job is to control fat without eliminating it.

WHAT FAT SUPPORTS

- Hormone production
- Brain function
- Cell membrane health
- Vitamin absorption (A, D, E, K)
- Meal satisfaction

FOOD	COMMON SERVING	APPROXIMATE CALORIES
Olive oil	1 tablespoon	About 120
Butter	1 tablespoon	About 100
Peanut butter	2 tablespoons	About 190
Almonds	Small handful	About 160
Heavy salad dressing	2 tablespoons	120 to 200
Cheese (hard, shredded)	1/4 cup	About 110

HIDDEN CALORIE TRAP

Fat calories are often invisible. Cooking oil, salad dressing, nut butter, and cheese can quietly add 400 to 600 calories per day. During fat loss phases, measure fats with a spoon, a cup, or a scale.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Control fat. Do not eliminate it. Measured fats fuel hormones and meals. Unmeasured fats sabotage the deficit.

Fiber and Whole Foods

Whole foods regulate appetite because they bring water, fiber, and physical volume. Calorie-dense, low-fiber foods do the opposite. The difference is the entire game during fat loss.

HIGH FULLNESS PER CALORIE

- Potatoes and sweet potatoes
- Lean meat, fish, eggs
- Greek yogurt, cottage cheese
- Vegetables of all kinds
- Fruit
- Oats
- Beans and lentils
- Air-popped popcorn

LOW FULLNESS PER CALORIE

- Cooking oils and butter
- Candy and sugary snacks
- Sugary drinks and juice
- Fried foods
- Pastries and baked goods
- Chips and crackers
- Heavy sauces and dressings
- Specialty coffee drinks

COACH'S NOTE

Fat loss is not a willpower problem. It is usually a satiety problem. Eat the foods that fill you up and a deficit becomes much easier to sustain.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Build meals from foods that produce fullness. Treat low-satiety foods as the small layer on top, not the foundation.

07

WHAT TO EAT

Food lists, meal templates, and practical choices
you can use immediately.

SECTION 07

THE DERIVN SYSTEM

Food List Master Reference

A practical, non-restrictive list of foods organized by their job in the system. Build most meals from these categories and the rest of your nutrition decisions become easier.

LEAN PROTEINS

BEST FOR: DEFAULT PROTEIN, FAT LOSS PHASES

Chicken breast | Turkey breast | White fish | Egg whites | 93% lean beef |
Greek yogurt | Cottage cheese | Tuna | Shrimp | Whey protein

PERFORMANCE PROTEINS BEST FOR: TRAINING PHASES, HIGHER-CALORIE DAYS

Whole eggs | Salmon | Lean steak | Chicken thighs | Turkey | Protein shakes

CARBOHYDRATE SOURCES

BEST FOR: TRAINING FUEL, POST-WORKOUT, PERFORMANCE DAYS

Rice | Potatoes | Sweet potatoes | Oats | Fruit | Pasta | Whole-grain bread |
Rice cakes | Beans | Legumes

FRUITS

BEST FOR: SNACKS, PRE-WORKOUT CARBS, SWEET CRAVINGS

Bananas | Berries | Apples | Oranges | Grapes | Pineapple | Watermelon |
Mango | Peaches | Pears

VEGETABLES

BEST FOR: VOLUME, FIBER, FAT LOSS MEALS, MICRONUTRIENTS

Spinach | Mixed greens | Broccoli | Peppers | Cucumbers | Zucchini | Green
beans | Carrots | Asparagus | Cabbage | Cauliflower | Brussels sprouts

HEALTHY FATS

BEST FOR: HORMONES, MEAL SATISFACTION, HIGHER-CALORIE MEALS

Avocado | Olive oil | Nuts (measured) | Nut butter (measured) | Whole eggs |
Salmon | Cheese (controlled)

CONVENIENCE FOODS

BEST FOR: BUSY DAYS, TRAVEL, WORK MEALS

Greek yogurt cups | Cottage cheese | Rotisserie chicken | Microwave rice | Frozen vegetables | Tuna packets | Turkey slices | Protein bars | Protein shakes | Hard-boiled eggs

LIMIT, DO NOT DEMONIZE

These foods are not bad. They are dense. Use them as flavor, not foundation:

Fried foods / sugary drinks / alcohol / candy / pastries / high-calorie coffee drinks / heavy sauces / unmeasured oils / large portions of nuts or nut butter / highly processed snacks

KEY TAKEAWAY

Do not moralize food. Build most meals from high-value foods. Control the rest. That is the entire approach.

The Meal Building Template

A meal becomes simple when the order is fixed. Protein first. Vegetables or fruit second. Carbs matched to activity. Fats controlled. Repeat for life.

BASIC DERIVN MEAL TEMPLATE

01 Protein first.

30 to 45 grams. Build the meal around it.

02 Vegetables or fruit second.

Volume, fiber, micronutrients.

03 Carbs matched to activity.

More on training days, less on rest days.

04 Fats controlled.

Measured. Not accidental.

FOUR PLATE TEMPLATES

FAT LOSS

- Lean protein
- Large vegetables
- Moderate carbs
- Low to moderate fats

PERFORMANCE

- Protein
- Larger carb serving
- Vegetables or fruit
- Moderate fats

REST DAY

- Protein
- More vegetables
- Smaller carb serving
- Controlled fats

BUSY DAY

- Convenience protein
- Microwave carb
- Frozen vegetable
- Minimal added fat

KEY TAKEAWAY

Meal building stops being a daily decision when the order is fixed. Pick the plate that matches the day, fill it, and move on.

Sample Meals

Real examples that fit the template. None of them are perfect. All of them are repeatable.

PRE-WORKOUT

Oats bowl	Oats with protein powder and berries
Greek yogurt	Banana with Greek yogurt and honey
Quick savory	Rice cakes with turkey and mustard
Small plate	Small rice bowl with chicken
On the go	Protein shake plus a piece of fruit

POST-WORKOUT

Classic	Chicken and rice with vegetables
Heavier	Lean beef with potatoes and greens
Cold and fast	Greek yogurt with oats and berries
Breakfast format	Eggs with toast and fruit
Travel format	Protein shake with banana

FAT LOSS MEALS

Bowl	Chicken salad bowl with vinaigrette (measured)
Plate	White fish with potatoes and vegetables
Comfort	Turkey burger bowl, no bun, with sweet potato
Scramble	Egg white scramble with vegetables
Snack meal	Greek yogurt with berries and a small drizzle of honey

PERFORMANCE MEALS

Bowl	Chicken rice bowl with vegetables
Plate	Lean steak with potatoes and asparagus
Pasta	Turkey pasta bowl with marinara
Fish	Salmon with rice and broccoli
Breakfast	Oats with protein and fruit

TRAVEL MEALS

Hotel	Rotisserie chicken and microwave rice
Airport	Greek yogurt and fruit
Cafe	Turkey sandwich with fruit
Quick	Protein shake and banana
Pantry	Tuna packet with rice cakes

QUICK APPLICATION

Pick three meals from each category that you would actually eat. Save them. Rotate. Most clients find that 8 to 10 meals on rotation covers 90% of their week. The other 10% is flexible.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Simple meals work when they hit the structure. You do not need variety. You need a rotation that you actually run.

Snacks and Substitutions

Substitution works better than restriction. The goal is not to give up the food you crave. It is to find a version that satisfies the craving at a sustainable cost.

INSTEAD OF	USE
Ice cream	Greek yogurt with berries and a drizzle of honey
Candy	Fruit, especially grapes, berries, oranges
Chips	Air-popped popcorn or rice cakes
Sugary latte	Coffee with a splash of milk, or an Americano
Soda	Sparkling water with citrus
Trail mix by the handful	Measured nuts plus fruit
Sugary cereal	Oats with cinnamon and protein powder

STRUCTURED SNACK OPTIONS

Keep these stocked. They cover most cravings without hidden calories.

Greek yogurt / cottage cheese / hard-boiled eggs / protein shake / turkey slices / fruit / protein bar (when needed) / popcorn / tuna packet / rice cakes with lean protein

KEY TAKEAWAY

Substitution works. Restriction usually does not. Find versions of the foods you like that cost less.

Fat Loss Nutrition

Fat loss is not about eating as little as possible. It is about creating a moderate deficit you can repeat. Most failures come from too aggressive a cut, too little protein, or untracked weekend calories.

01 Create a 300 to 500 calorie deficit.

Sustainable. Repeatable. Conservative on muscle and recovery.

02 Keep protein high.

0.8 to 1.0 grams per pound. Non-negotiable in a deficit.

03 Keep strength training in the plan.

Removing it during fat loss accelerates muscle loss.

04 Maintain running.

Do not add endless cardio to compensate for unsustainable food choices.

05 Reduce hidden calories first.

Oils, sauces, drinks, and snacks before cutting meals.

06 Track weekly averages.

Daily scale weight is noise. Weekly average is signal.

07 Use 8 to 12 week deficit phases.

Then take a 4 to 8 week maintenance phase before the next.

IF WEIGHT HAS NOT MOVED IN 3 WEEKS

01 Track intake honestly for 7 days.

No estimates. No skipped entries.

02 Audit oils, drinks, sauces, and snacks.

Hidden calories live here.

03 Check your weekend eating.

Friday to Sunday usually erases the deficit.

04 Confirm your protein.

Underfed on protein, overfed on everything else.

05 Reduce 100 to 150 calories or add steps.

Small adjustment, not an overhaul.

06 If dieting 10+ weeks, take a maintenance phase.

The body adapts. Reset and resume.

KEY TAKEAWAY

The best fat loss plan is the smallest one that works. The deficit you can repeat for 8 weeks beats the one you abandon at week 3.

Performance Nutrition

There are times to diet and times to fuel. Performance phases support strength gains, running output, and recovery. You cannot live in a deficit forever and expect the system to keep producing.

PERFORMANCE PHASE RULES

- Eat at maintenance or a slight surplus.
- Keep protein at 0.8 to 1.0 grams per pound.
- Increase carbohydrates around training.
- Keep fats moderate, not maximal.
- Fuel hard sessions before and after.
- Do not fear small scale increases from glycogen and water.

PHASE	CALORIES	CARBS	GOAL
Fat loss	Deficit	Moderate	Lose fat, maintain muscle.
Performance	Maintenance to slight surplus	Higher	Train harder, recover better, build muscle.
Maintenance	Around expenditure	Matched to activity	Hold results and recover.

COACH'S NOTE

Most people would benefit from spending more time at maintenance and less time in a deficit. Maintenance is not stagnation. It is where the body consolidates progress and rebuilds capacity for the next push.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Diet phases and performance phases serve different goals. Cycle between them. Living in either one for too long produces diminishing returns.

08

RECOVERY AND DURABILITY

How to protect progress and keep training for
years.

SECTION 08

THE DERIVN SYSTEM

Recovery Is Not Passive

Training creates demand. Recovery converts demand into adaptation. If recovery is treated as the absence of training, the body never finishes the job the workout started.

THE RECOVERY VARIABLES

Adaptation is built from a small list of inputs. Most plateaus, soreness, and stalled progress trace back to one of these being neglected.

Sleep	The single highest-return recovery tool. Aim for 7 to 9 hours.
Nutrition	Protein at every meal, carbs around training, enough total calories.
Training spacing	Hard sessions separated by 48 hours. One full rest day per week.
Stress management	Life stress and training stress draw from the same recovery budget.
Hydration	Water with meals and around training. Salt if sweating heavily.
Mobility	Ten minutes daily to maintain range and joint health.
Deloading	A planned lighter week every four to six weeks.

RECOVERY SCORECARD

Run through this most days. Two or more no answers in a row is a signal to reduce volume or intensity.

- ☐ Did I sleep at least 7 hours last night?
- ☐ Did I eat protein at each meal?
- ☐ Did I fuel around training with carbs?
- ☐ Is soreness resolving within 48 hours?
- ☐ Is my resting heart rate in its normal range?
- ☐ Am I motivated enough to train today?
- ☐ Are my joints pain-free during normal movement?

KEY TAKEAWAY

Recovery is the half of training where the body actually changes. Track it like you track sets and reps.

Sleep

Sleep is the highest-return recovery tool. No supplement, modality, or technique replaces what 7 to 9 hours of consistent sleep does for strength, body composition, and mood.

DO THIS

- Target 7 to 9 hours nightly
- Keep sleep and wake times consistent, including weekends
- Cool, dark room
- Limit screens 30 to 60 minutes before bed
- Avoid caffeine after early afternoon
- Finish large meals 2 hours before bed

AVOID THIS

- Cutting sleep to add a workout
- Variable bedtimes (off by 90+ minutes)
- Late afternoon or evening caffeine
- Heavy alcohol within 3 hours of bed
- Phone in bed scrolling until sleep
- Treating bad sleep as a non-issue

IF YOU MUST CHOOSE

If the choice is between cutting sleep and adding a workout, choose sleep. A workout performed on six hours of sleep is a worse workout, a worse recovery day, and a worse next session.

WHEN SLEEP IS DISRUPTED

Travel, sick kids, work crunches, and shift schedules happen. The goal during these stretches is not perfection. It is protecting what you can.

- Drop hard training to maintenance volume.
- Keep easy runs and walks. Skip threshold and intervals.
- Hold protein steady. Hunger and cravings rise on poor sleep.
- Resume normal training the day after one good night.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Protect sleep first. Everything else, including training output, depends on it.

Mobility vs Stretching

Stretching lengthens passively. Mobility builds active control through useful ranges. Both have a place, but mobility is the one that protects training and improves performance.

STRETCHING	MOBILITY
Passive lengthening	Active control through range
Best after training	Useful before and after training
Improves tolerance to length	Improves performance and injury resistance
Held positions	Controlled movement under tension

PRIORITY AREAS

Most adults need work in the same four regions. Hit these and the body becomes noticeably easier to load.

- **Hips.** Flexion, extension, and rotation. Tight hips overload the lower back.
- **Ankles.** Dorsiflexion limits squat depth and running mechanics.
- **Thoracic spine.** Rotation and extension. Sitting closes this off all day.
- **Shoulders.** Overhead reach without compensating from the lower back.

DAILY 10-MINUTE ROUTINE

- Hip CARs, 2 minutes (1 minute per side)
- Ankle rocks against a wall, 2 minutes
- Thoracic rotations on the floor, 2 minutes
- Shoulder CARs, 2 minutes
- Deep squat hold or hip flexor stretch, 2 minutes

COACH NOTE

Ten minutes daily beats 60 minutes once a week. The goal is maintenance, not a yoga practice. Stack it with coffee, podcasts, or while dinner cooks.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Mobility is active control. Ten minutes a day in the right places protects every lift and every run.

Fatigue Management

Fatigue is data, not weakness. The body is telling you what it can absorb. The skill is reading the signal early, before performance, sleep, or motivation collapse.

NORMAL

All Systems Steady

Normal soreness that clears in 48 hours. Stable performance. Sleep is solid. Motivation is steady. Continue training as planned.

CAUTION

Reduce Load

Performance feels off. Soreness lingers past 48 hours. Stress is up or sleep is short. Reduce volume by 20 to 30 percent. Hold intensity steady.

STOP

Reset Required

Joint pain. Sleep is broken. Performance is dropping week over week. Resting heart rate elevated. Deload, reduce intensity, or take rest days.

FATIGUE TOOLS, IN ORDER

When caution signs turn toward stop signs, use the lightest tool first. Most cases are solved with one or two adjustments, not a full rebuild.

01 Reduce volume.

Cut sets per session by 20 to 30 percent before changing anything else.

02 Reduce intensity.

Lower load by 10 to 15 percent and keep movement quality high.

03 Add a rest day.

One unplanned rest day this week is cheaper than three forced rest days next week.

04 Extend sleep.

An extra hour for 3 to 5 nights resets most caution-zone fatigue.

05 Remove hard running.

Threshold and intervals out. Easy Zone 2 stays.

06 **Deload.**

If multiple flags persist for over a week, run a planned lighter week.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Fatigue is information. Read it early, adjust small, and the system stays in motion.

Deloading

A deload is a planned recovery week. It removes accumulated fatigue while keeping movement patterns sharp. Skip deloads long enough and the body will schedule one for you, usually as an injury or a stall.

WHEN TO DELOAD

- Every 4 to 6 weeks of consistent training
- After any heavy testing block
- When caution-zone fatigue persists past a week
- Before a high-stress life period (travel, work crunch, family event)
- Any time strength has stalled for two weeks in a row

DELOAD STRUCTURE

The goal is reduced fatigue without losing the training pattern. Keep the exercises. Cut the volume and load. Hold quality high.

SYSTEM	DELOAD ADJUSTMENT
Strength volume	Reduce sets by 30 to 50 percent
Strength load	Reduce by 10 to 20 percent on compounds
Exercise selection	Keep the same lifts, keep movement quality high
Running distance	Reduce weekly mileage by 30 percent
Running intensity	Easy Zone 2 only. No threshold, no intervals
Mobility	Maintain or slightly increase
Nutrition	Hold protein steady. Calories at maintenance.

COACH NOTE

Most lifters resist deloads because they feel like lost progress. Deloads do not erase progress. They reveal it by removing the fatigue that was masking your real strength.

KEY TAKEAWAY

A planned light week protects months of hard weeks. Deload before the body forces you to.

09

HABITS AND CONSISTENCY

| How to make the system survive real life.
SECTION 09

THE DERIVN SYSTEM

Structure Beats Motivation

Consistency is not a personality trait. It is the product of structure.
Motivated people build systems so they do not have to rely on motivation.

STRUCTURES THAT DRIVE CONSISTENCY

The goal is to remove decisions. Each of these reduces the friction between intention and action.

- **Fixed weekly training schedule.** Same days, same slots. Treat them like meetings.
- **Default meal framework.** Three or four meals you can build without thinking.
- **Prepared training gear.** Bag packed the night before. Clothes laid out.
- **Minimum viable session.** A short version of every workout, ready for bad days.
- **Food environment control.** Stock what supports the system. Limit what derails it.
- **Weekly planning ritual.** 15 minutes on Sunday to set the week.

THE SUNDAY SETUP

A short ritual that protects the entire week. Aim for 15 minutes.

- ☐ Pick training days for the week
- ☐ Pick running days and which run is the quality run
- ☐ Plan 3 to 4 default meals
- ☐ Buy protein and produce for the week
- ☐ Prep 2 to 3 simple foods (cook rice, grill chicken, hard-boil eggs)
- ☐ Pack gym bag and lay out training clothes
- ☐ Check the calendar for travel, late nights, or conflicts
- ☐ Set minimum sessions for the busy days

KEY TAKEAWAY

Decide once. Then follow the structure. Motivation is a bonus, not a requirement.

Never Miss Twice

One miss is normal. Two misses is the start of the spiral. The rule is simple: when you miss, the next scheduled action happens, on time, as planned.

THE RULE

One miss is normal. Two misses is a pattern. Return to the next normal action.

APPLY IT ACROSS THE SYSTEM

Training	Missed a workout? The next scheduled session happens. Do not double up.
Nutrition	Off-plan meal? The next meal returns to the template. No punishment.
Running	Missed a run? The next run happens as scheduled. No make-up mileage.
Sleep	Bad night? Protect the next night.
Mobility	Skipped the day? Ten minutes tomorrow, no extra session.

DO THIS

- Resume the next normal action
- Treat the miss as one data point
- Adjust the schedule if the pattern keeps repeating
- Protect the streak from going to two

AVOID THIS

- Punishing yourself with extra cardio
- Slashing calories the next day
- Doubling the next workout
- Restarting next Monday
- Treating one miss as a failed week

COACH NOTE

The damage from a missed workout is small. The damage from spiraling into a missed week, then a missed month, is enormous. Protect the rule, and most missed sessions become invisible in the trend.

KEY TAKEAWAY

The correction is not punishment. The correction is resuming the system at the next normal action.

Minimum Viable Session

When life is full, do not skip the habit. Reduce the session. The point is to keep the pattern alive. Small sessions on hard weeks protect months of progress.

THREE TEMPLATES FOR TIGHT DAYS

30-MINUTE SESSION

- 3 to 5 minutes of warm-up
- Primary compound, 3 to 4 sets
- Secondary movement, 3 sets
- Core or carry, 2 sets
- Quick cooldown

20-MINUTE EMERGENCY SESSION

- 3 rounds of: squat or hinge, push, pull, core
- Pick load that is challenging by round 3
- Move with quality. Skip if a movement aggravates a joint.

10-MINUTE MOVEMENT SESSION

- Bodyweight squats
- Push-ups
- Rows or band pulls
- Plank
- Mobility flow to finish

THE RULE

If the choice is between the planned 60-minute session and nothing, do the 20-minute version. The habit matters more than the volume on any single day.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Something always beats nothing. The minimum viable session keeps the streak alive on the days that would otherwise break it.

Training Around Real Life

The system is built to bend before it breaks. Travel, stress, time pressure, and low motivation are not failures of the plan. They are scenarios the plan is supposed to handle.

WHEN YOU ARE TRAVELING

- Use the hotel gym or run a bodyweight session in the room.
- Walk or run outside whenever possible.
- Keep protein high. Rotisserie chicken, Greek yogurt, and tuna packets travel well.
- Do not try to match normal training volume. Maintain the pattern.

WHEN WORK IS STRESSFUL

- Reduce volume by 20 to 30 percent across the week.
- Keep easy runs only. Cut threshold and intervals.
- Prioritize sleep over any added training.
- Hold protein steady. Hunger and cravings rise under stress.

WHEN TIME IS LIMITED

- Use the 20 or 30-minute templates.
- Cut accessory work first. Keep the compound lifts.
- Combine an easy run with a walk or commute.

WHEN MOTIVATION IS LOW

- Start the warm-up. Just the warm-up.
- Commit to the first exercise only.
- Continue if momentum builds. Stop if it does not.
- Either way, the habit was honored.

COACH NOTE

The lifters and runners who train for decades are not the ones who do every session perfectly. They are the ones who know how to scale down without quitting.

KEY TAKEAWAY

The system bends. It does not break. Every life scenario has a smaller, smarter version of the plan.

10

MEASURING PROGRESS

| How to know if the system is working.
SECTION 10

THE DERIVN SYSTEM

Measurement Basics

Measurement replaces guessing with evidence. The goal is not surveillance. The goal is enough data to know whether the system is working and where to adjust when it is not.

THE MINIMUM TRACKING SYSTEM

Five inputs cover almost every adjustment decision. Skip any of them and decisions become guesses.

WHAT	HOW OFTEN	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
Training log	Every session	Whether progressive overload is happening
Body weight	Daily, average weekly	Direction of body composition change
Running log	Every run	Whether mileage and pace are progressing
Progress photos	Every 2 to 4 weeks	What the scale cannot see
Waist measurement	Every 2 weeks	Body composition trend during fat loss

RULES OF MEASUREMENT

- Compare across weeks, not days.
- Same time, same conditions, same equipment.
- Measure to inform decisions, not to judge yourself.
- If a metric is not changing decisions, stop tracking it.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Track the few inputs that drive decisions. Ignore the noise. Trends, not single data points, tell you what is working.

Strength Benchmarks

Benchmarks are reference points, not ego targets. Use them to know where you are, and to set realistic next-step goals across the major movement patterns.

Numbers are expressed as bodyweight ratios so they apply to any size lifter. All targets assume controlled form, full range of motion, and 1 to 2 reps in reserve.

LIFT	FOUNDATIONAL	CAPABLE	ADVANCED
Back Squat	0.75x BW for 5	1.25x BW for 5	1.75x BW for 5
Deadlift	1.0x BW for 5	1.5x BW for 5	2.0x BW for 5
Dumbbell Bench	DBs total 50% BW for 8	DBs total 75% BW for 8	DBs total BW for 8
Pull-Ups	3 strict	10 strict	15 strict or weighted
Bulgarian Split Squat	BW for 8 per side	DBs total 50% BW for 8	DBs total 75% BW for 8

HOW TO USE THESE

Identify your tier on each lift. Where you are below Foundational, build there first. Where you sit between tiers, that is your next 12 to 24-week target. Strength is rarely uniform across patterns. That is normal.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Benchmarks point the direction. They are not a finish line. The job is steady, controlled progression across all five patterns.

Running Benchmarks

Running progress is not just faster pace. It is the same pace at lower effort, longer durations at the same heart rate, and harder sessions absorbed without breaking down.

CAPACITY	FOUNDATIONAL	CAPABLE	ADVANCED
Zone 2 Duration	20 min continuous	40 min continuous	60 min continuous
Comfortable Distance	2 miles	4 to 5 miles	6 to 8 miles
Threshold Hold	10 min controlled	20 min controlled	30 min controlled
Weekly Volume	8 to 12 miles	15 to 20 miles	25 to 35 miles

TRACKING EFFICIENCY OVER TIME

Pace alone does not tell the full story. The clearest signal of aerobic improvement is the same pace becoming easier, or the same effort producing a faster pace.

- Run the same easy route monthly at the same effort. Track time and how it felt.
- If you have a heart rate monitor, watch for the same pace at lower heart rate.
- Use the talk test as a backup. Easy should always feel easy.

COACH NOTE

Most adult runners overweight pace and underweight volume and ease. Building a real aerobic base shows up first in how easy your easy runs feel. Speed comes after.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Easier easy runs are progress. Longer Zone 2 is progress. Pace is the last thing to chase.

Body Composition Tracking

Scale weight is useful but incomplete. It moves with hydration, glycogen, food in the gut, sleep, and stress. The full picture requires more than one input.

TRACK THESE TOGETHER

Weekly average body weight	Daily weigh-ins, averaged across 7 days. Trends over weeks.
Progress photos	Every 2 to 4 weeks. The scale cannot see what photos see.
Waist measurement	At the navel, every 2 weeks. Sensitive to body fat changes.
Clothing fit	How a specific pair of pants or shirt fits over time.
Strength maintenance	If lifts are holding or progressing, you are not losing muscle.
Energy and performance	Workouts feel solid. Sleep is good. Mood is stable.

PHOTO PROTOCOL

- Same time of day (morning, before food)
- Same lighting and location
- Same clothing (minimal, fitted)
- Front, side, back angles
- Every 2 to 4 weeks
- Compare across an 8-week minimum window

AVOID

- Reading a single daily weight as progress or regression
- Comparing a Monday weigh-in to a Friday weigh-in
- Trusting body fat percentage from consumer scales
- Comparing yourself to a different lighting, different angle photo from social media

KEY TAKEAWAY

Daily scale weight is noise. Weekly trends, photos, and waist measurements together are signal.

Adjusting When Progress Slows

When progress stalls, the instinct is to change everything. The right move is the opposite: diagnose the limiting variable, change one thing, and watch the next two weeks of data.

If strength stalls, check in this order:

CHECK FIRST

- Sleep (7+ hours?)
- Protein (0.8 to 1.0 g/lb?)
- Progressive overload (logged?)
- Fatigue (caution-zone signs?)

THEN ADJUST

- Deload for one week
- Adjust rep ranges or volume
- Change exercise variations
- Reassess after 2 weeks

If fat loss stalls, check in this order:

CHECK FIRST

- Track intake for 7 days
- Audit oils, drinks, sauces, snacks
- Check weekend eating
- Confirm protein

THEN ADJUST

- Reduce intake by 100 to 150 kcal
- Or add daily steps
- If dieting 10+ weeks, take a maintenance phase

If running stalls, check in this order:

CHECK FIRST

- Are easy runs actually easy?
- Did mileage jump too fast?
- Is the hard run too close to leg day?
- Is recovery on track?

THEN ADJUST

- Slow easy runs more
- Hold mileage for 2 weeks
- Move the hard run further from leg day
- Add structure, not random effort

KEY TAKEAWAY

Do not change everything when progress slows. Diagnose, change one variable, and let the next two weeks of data tell you the answer.

11

COMMON MISTAKES

The predictable errors that stall progress and how to correct them.

SECTION 11

THE DERIVN SYSTEM

Training Mistakes

Most plateaus come from execution errors, not a broken program. The list below covers seven mistakes that account for the majority of stalled progress in the gym.

MISTAKE	WHY IT STALLS PROGRESS	THE FIX
Changing programs too often	The body never gets to adapt to a stimulus.	Commit to one program for 8 weeks before judging it.
No progressive overload	Same weight, same reps, week after week. No reason to adapt.	Track sets, reps, and load. Add to one of them weekly.
Ego lifting	Heavier numbers with worse form. Risk goes up. Real strength does not.	Use full range and controlled tempo. Drop load to fix it.
Neglecting the posterior chain	Front-side dominance creates posture and joint problems.	Pull at least as much as you push. Hinge weekly.
Skiping warm-ups	Cold tissue, poor activation, lower output, higher injury risk.	5 to 10 minutes of activation before every session.
Training to failure too often	Excess fatigue with no extra adaptation. Recovery suffers.	Use 1 to 3 reps in reserve on compounds.
Ignoring recovery signals	Volume creeps up. Sleep drops. Burnout follows.	Reduce volume before the body forces you to.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Most training plateaus are execution problems, not programming problems. Fix the basics first, then change the plan.

Running Mistakes

Most running problems come from too much intensity, too soon, too often. The fixes are simple but require honesty about pace, mileage, and placement.

MISTAKE	WHY IT STALLS PROGRESS	THE FIX
Running easy days too fast	Easy days become moderate days. No real recovery, no real adaptation.	Use the talk test. If you cannot speak in full sentences, slow down.
Increasing mileage too fast	Connective tissue lags behind cardiovascular fitness. Injuries follow.	Increase weekly mileage by no more than 10 percent.
Hard run before heavy legs	Compounding fatigue degrades both sessions.	Separate hard runs and heavy lower body by 48 hours.
Skipping warm-ups before quality runs	First 10 minutes are wasted. Risk goes up.	10-minute easy jog plus 4 to 6 strides before any hard work.
Measuring only pace	Pace varies with weather, fatigue, terrain. Misreads progress.	Track effort, heart rate, and how the run felt.
Dropping running during strength phases	Aerobic base evaporates fast. Recovery between sets gets worse.	Keep 1 to 2 easy runs even in strength-priority blocks.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Easy easy. Hard hard. Add mileage slowly. Do not run hard the day before or after heavy legs.

Nutrition Mistakes

Fat loss usually fails because the deficit is not actually present. These seven mistakes account for most of the gap between intended intake and real intake.

MISTAKE	WHY IT STALLS PROGRESS	THE FIX
Assuming a deficit exists	Estimated calories rarely match real calories.	Track intake honestly for 7 days. Adjust from there.
Ignoring liquid calories	Coffee drinks, juice, alcohol, and smoothies hide hundreds of calories.	Audit all liquids. Switch defaults: coffee with milk, sparkling water, simple drinks.
Underestimating oils and fats	One tablespoon of oil is around 120 kcal. Pans get heavy pours.	Measure cooking fats during fat loss phases.
Eating too little protein	More hunger, more muscle loss, worse recovery.	30 to 45 grams per meal across 3 to 4 meals.
Weekend overeating	Five good days erased by two large weekend days.	Apply the same awareness on weekends. Plan, do not wing it.
Cutting calories too aggressively	Hunger spikes, training output drops, the diet collapses.	Use a 300 to 500 kcal deficit you can actually sustain.
Trying to out-train diet	Adding cardio without adjusting intake rarely works.	Use nutrition as the main fat loss lever. Training as the multiplier.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Fat loss fails most often because the deficit is real on paper and absent in reality. Track honestly. Adjust slowly.

Recovery Mistakes

Burnout is rarely sudden. It is the result of ignored recovery signals repeated for weeks. These five mistakes are the most common path to it.

MISTAKE	WHY IT STALLS PROGRESS	THE FIX
Never deloading	Fatigue accumulates. Performance drops. Risk rises.	Plan a deload every 4 to 6 weeks of consistent training.
Sleeping too little	Strength, body composition, and mood all degrade together.	7 to 9 hours. Protect bedtime like a training appointment.
Training through pain	Small irritations turn into chronic injuries.	Modify the movement, reduce the load, or rest the joint.
Overtraining during high-stress periods	Stress is a recovery cost too. Training piles on top of it.	Reduce volume by 20 to 30 percent during stressful weeks.
Treating recovery as optional	Adaptation never finishes. Progress flatlines.	Track recovery like training. Sleep, soreness, mood, joints.

COACH NOTE

Recovery mistakes feel invisible because they compound slowly. Most clients realize they overtrained only when performance has been dropping for weeks. The earlier you catch it, the smaller the correction needs to be.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Burnout is the result of ignored signals, not bad luck. Track recovery, deload on schedule, and respect the days the body asks for less.

12

THE DERIVN CODE

| The rules and standards that keep the system running.

The Built for Motion Rules

Ten rules. When the plan feels uncertain, when life shifts, when motivation runs low, return here. These are the principles every other decision in the system traces back to.

01 Train for capability, not just appearance.

A capable body looks better because it performs better. Strength, conditioning, and mobility are the inputs. Body composition is the output.

02 Never miss twice.

One miss is normal. Two misses is the start of the spiral. Return to the next normal action, on time, as planned.

03 Compound before isolation.

If time is limited, keep the squat, hinge, push, pull, and carry. Cut the fluff first.

04 The posterior chain is a priority.

The back side of the body protects the joints, builds posture, and powers running. Most adults need to pull more than they push.

05 Run.

Cardiovascular fitness is non-negotiable. It supports recovery, body composition, and long-term durability.

06 Protein at every meal.

Protein anchors recovery, satiety, and muscle retention. 30 to 45 grams per meal, 3 to 4 times per day.

07 Control what you can measure.

What gets tracked gets managed. Training log, weekly weight average, photos, and waist when fat loss is the goal.

08 Recovery is training.

Training creates demand. Recovery creates adaptation. Sleep, food, mobility, and deloads are part of the program, not extras.

09 Sustainability beats intensity.

The plan must survive real life. A passing week repeated for months beats a perfect week followed by a collapse.

10 The system is the goal.

Build the system and the outputs follow. Body, performance, and confidence are the byproducts of structure.

KEY TAKEAWAY

When unsure, return to the rules. Every decision in the handbook traces back to one of them.

Non-Negotiable Standards

Standards are the floor. Exceed them when life allows. Meet them when life is hard. As long as these minimums hold, the system keeps producing.

DOMAIN	MINIMUM STANDARD	WHY IT MATTERS
Strength training	3 sessions per week	Maintains the strength stimulus and muscle mass.
Running and conditioning	2 easy runs or conditioning sessions per week	Maintains aerobic base and recovery capacity.
Nutrition	Protein at every meal	Protects muscle, controls hunger, anchors recovery.
Sleep	7 hours minimum	Supports adaptation, mood, and decision-making.
Mobility	10 minutes daily	Maintains range and joint health for long-term training.
Measurement	Training log, weekly weight average, progress photos	Provides the data needed to adjust intelligently.

HOW TO USE THE STANDARDS

- If you are hitting all six, the system is running.
- If one is slipping, fix that one before adding anything new.
- If multiple are slipping, you are in a stress period. Reduce, do not abandon.
- If you cannot hit the floor for two weeks straight, the schedule needs reworking, not more willpower.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Standards are the floor, not the ceiling. Hold the minimums and the system holds the outputs.

13

START IMMEDIATELY

| How to begin without overthinking.
SECTION 13

THE DERIVN SYSTEM

The First 24 Hours

The system starts with one action, not a perfect plan. The next 24 hours are about momentum. Six small steps make the rest of the week obvious.

TODAY

- ☐ Set your training days for this week (mark them on your calendar)
- ☐ Eat protein at your next meal, 30 to 45 grams
- ☐ Go for a 20-minute walk or easy run
- ☐ Track one day of food without trying to change anything
- ☐ Lay out your training clothes and pack your gym bag
- ☐ Choose your first session and read it before the day is over

TONIGHT BEFORE BED

- Set a wake-up time that gives you at least 7 hours of sleep.
- Put your phone outside the bedroom or across the room.
- Confirm tomorrow's first session is on the calendar.

COACH NOTE

Do not try to install the entire system in one day. The point of day one is to do one thing the new way. Eat one high-protein meal. Take one walk. Pack the bag. Tomorrow becomes obvious.

KEY TAKEAWAY

The first day is about action, not optimization. One protein meal, one walk, one packed bag, one scheduled session.

The First 7 Days

The first week is about awareness and rhythm, not transformation. You are not trying to be perfect. You are trying to learn what your real baseline is, so you know what to adjust.

WEEK ONE CHECKLIST

TRAINING AND MOVEMENT

- ☐ Train 3 times this week
- ☐ Run or walk 2 times
- ☐ Do 10 minutes of mobility daily

NUTRITION

- ☐ Eat protein at every meal
- ☐ Track food daily, just for awareness
- ☐ Measure cooking oil at least once
- ☐ Audit liquid calories (coffee drinks, juice, alcohol)

BASELINE MEASUREMENTS

- ☐ Take starting progress photos (front, side, back)
- ☐ Weigh-in daily, calculate the weekly average
- ☐ Record starting strength numbers on key lifts
- ☐ Run the same easy route once. Note time and effort.

AVOID THIS WEEK

- Trying to install everything at once
- Cutting calories aggressively
- Adding extra cardio to compensate for one missed workout
- Judging the week before it ends

KEY TAKEAWAY

Week one builds the rhythm and the baseline. Real change starts in week two.

The First 30 Days

The first 30 days are about becoming someone who follows the system. Each week adds a small layer. Nothing is rushed. By day 30, the structure is the default, not the experiment.

DAYS 1 TO 7**Establish Rhythm**

- 3 strength sessions, 2 easy runs or walks
 - Protein at every meal
 - 10 minutes of mobility daily
 - Track food for awareness, no aggressive changes
 - Take baseline photos and lift numbers
-

DAYS 8 TO 14**Refine Loads and Meals**

- Settle on working weights for primary lifts
 - Lock in 3 to 4 default meals you actually like
 - Measure cooking oils consistently
 - Add one structured running session
 - Confirm Sunday Setup ritual
-

DAYS 15 TO 21**Build Running and Mobility**

- Two Zone 2 runs of 25 to 35 minutes
 - Begin progressive overload on compounds
 - Mobility daily, with priority areas dialed in
 - First check on weekly weight average and waist
-

DAYS 22 TO 30**Track Progress and Adjust**

- Compare progress photos to day one
 - Review training log for overload trends
 - Adjust calories or activity based on weight trend
 - Pick the priority for month two
-

END-OF-MONTH REVIEW

- ☐ Did I train 3 times most weeks?
- ☐ Did I run or walk 2 times most weeks?
- ☐ Did I eat protein at most meals?
- ☐ Did I track enough to understand my intake?
- ☐ Did I avoid missing twice in a row?

KEY TAKEAWAY

The first 30 days are about becoming someone who follows the system. The body composition follows the identity.

The First 12 Weeks

Do not install the full system overnight. Build it in three phases. By week 12, the structure is your default and the data tells you exactly where to go next.

WEEKS 1 TO 4

Foundation

- Learn the movements: squat, hinge, push, pull, carry
 - Build the meal structure and default plates
 - Establish 2 easy runs per week
 - Track baseline strength, body weight, and photos
 - Lock in mobility as a daily habit
-

WEEKS 5 TO 8

Progression

- Add progressive overload on the major lifts
 - Add one quality run per week (threshold or intervals)
 - Tighten protein consistency (3 to 4 meals daily)
 - Begin tracking trends, not single data points
 - Run a deload week if needed
-

WEEKS 9 TO 12

Integration

- Adjust nutrition based on 8 weeks of data
 - Refine the weekly schedule around real life
 - Review benchmarks and set the next 12-week targets
 - Plan a deload between blocks
 - Choose the next priority: fat loss, strength, or running focus
-

12-WEEK REVIEW QUESTIONS

- Are the standards holding consistently?
- Is strength progressing on at least three of the major lifts?
- Has running base extended in duration or volume?
- Has body weight, waist, or photos moved in the desired direction?
- What is the single biggest limiter for the next 12 weeks?

KEY TAKEAWAY

Foundation, then progression, then integration. Three phases. Twelve weeks. The system becomes the default.

BUILT FOR MOTION / CLOSING

A body and a routine you can keep.

Built for Motion is not about chasing the hardest version of fitness. It is about building the version that lasts.

A body that can lift, run, move, recover, and keep showing up is more valuable than a body built through short bursts of unsustainable intensity.

The system works when you work the system.

Train with structure.

Eat with awareness.

Run with patience.

Recover with intention.

Measure honestly.

Adjust intelligently.

Never miss twice.

The goal is not perfection. The goal is a body and routine you can keep.